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Austin

Winter Weather

Hazard-Specific Annex



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WINTER WEATHER

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Record of Changes

Number	Date	Description	Initials
All	10/17/25	Developed annex	SH, CS, NC, LG, JR, MC
All	04/30/26	Updated annex	AA, LG

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Approval and Implementation

This annex applies to the City of Austin, and Travis County, its agencies, boards, commissions, and departments assigned responsibilities under this annex, as well as to all others designated by city and county policies. This annex is hereby approved for implementation and supersedes all previous editions.

Jim Redick

Jim Redick, MPA, CEM
Director
Austin Emergency Management

07-08-2026
Date

Signed by:
Patrick Phillips
0D0855B1994E411...

Patrick Phillips
Interim Chief Emergency Management Coordinator
Office of Emergency Management-
Travis County

7/10/2026
Date

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WINTER WEATHER

Hazard-Specific Annex



Purpose and Scope

The purpose of this Hazard-Specific Annex is to provide a contextual framework and response capability by which the city and its partners can effectively respond to winter weather events. It is designed to not only meet the legal mandates outlined by State and local code in the areas of emergency services and emergency management, but to do so with unity of effort among all participating agencies.

Background

Winter weather events can develop rapidly and may occur at any time during the cold season when atmospheric and surface conditions align. Under favorable meteorological conditions, winter storms may impact large geographic areas or remain localized, producing snow, sleet, freezing rain, extreme cold, or combinations of these hazards. Even brief winter weather events can result in disproportionate impacts to transportation systems, utilities, public safety operations, and critical infrastructure, particularly in regions with limited winter weather mitigation capability. The National Weather Service (NWS) identifies winter weather as a leading cause of hazardous travel and infrastructure disruption in areas unaccustomed to frozen precipitation. (Source)

The NWS defines a winter storm as a weather event producing significant snowfall, sleet, or ice accumulation, often accompanied by freezing temperatures, reduced visibility, and hazardous travel conditions. Winter storms may last only a few hours or persist for several days and can range in severity from minor travel disruptions to widespread infrastructure failure. Societal impacts are influenced not only by meteorological intensity but also by population exposure and infrastructure vulnerability.

Winter storms often begin with subtle changes in temperature or precipitation type and can quickly escalate as surface temperatures fall below freezing. In Central Texas, freezing rain and sleet represent the most hazardous forms of winter precipitation due to limited roadway treatment resources and low public familiarity with winter driving conditions. Ice accumulation on roadways, bridges, power lines, trees, a946830nd elevated surfaces frequently leads to vehicle collisions, power outages, blocked transportation corridors, and hazardous conditions for emergency responders.

NWS defines sleet as raindrops that freeze into ice pellets before reaching the ground. Although sleet may initially bounce upon impact, it can accumulate and create slick driving conditions similar to snow. Freezing rain is defined as rain that falls in liquid form and freezes on contact with surfaces at or below 32°F (0°C), forming a glaze of ice. Even light ice accumulation can cause significant hazards, particularly on untreated roadways, power lines, and tree canopies. Ice storms occur when prolonged freezing rain results in substantial ice accretion, often leading to widespread power outages and infrastructure damage.

A freeze is defined by the NWS as temperatures falling to 32°F (0°C) or below. A hard freeze occurs when temperatures fall to 28°F (-2°C) or lower for an extended period, posing a high risk to exposed infrastructure, water systems, vegetation, and agriculture. Prolonged freezing temperatures also increase public health risks, including hypothermia and carbon monoxide poisoning associated with unsafe heating practices.

The NWS issues winter weather forecast products to communicate anticipated severity and impacts and to support preparedness and response actions. A Winter Weather Advisory is issued for conditions that may cause significant inconvenience and hazardous travel. A Winter Storm Watch is issued when there is potential for significant winter weather within 24 to 48 hours. Winter Storm Warnings and Ice Storm Warnings are issued

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when hazardous winter weather is imminent or occurring and poses a serious threat to life and property. These products serve as primary decision-support tools for emergency management agencies and partner organizations.

Winter storms vary significantly in duration, intensity, and geographic extent. Some events may consist of light wintry precipitation over a few hours, while others may persist for several days and affect large portions of the state. Winter storms are often accompanied by strong winds and reduced visibility, further exacerbating transportation hazards and complicating emergency response and recovery operations.

In the Austin area, significant wintry precipitation, defined as freezing rain, sleet, or snow sufficient to cause substantial impacts to travel and daily activities, occurs on average approximately once every two years. The largest recorded snowstorm occurred on November 22–23, 1937, when approximately 11 inches of snow were recorded. More recently, the February 14–15, 2021 winter storm produced 6.4 inches of snow at Austin Bergstrom International Airport and Austin Mabry, accompanied by prolonged freezing temperatures that resulted in widespread power outages, water system failures, and cascading impacts across multiple sectors.

Normal winter precipitation (December–February) in Austin averages approximately 7.25 inches, accounting for roughly 20 percent of annual precipitation. Winter weather in Central Texas is highly variable, and periods of extreme cold may be interspersed with unusually warm winter days. This variability complicates forecasting, preparedness activities, and public messaging efforts.
(Source)

Winter weather hazards pose a significant risk to life safety, critical infrastructure, and continuity of operations. Ice accumulation and freezing temperatures can overwhelm transportation networks, disrupt utility services, strain emergency response capabilities, and disproportionately impact vulnerable populations. Coordinated preparedness, timely warnings, and effective response planning are essential to reduce the cascading effects of winter weather events across the community.

Hazard Definition

A freeze is defined as meteorological conditions in which temperatures fall to or below 32°F (0°C), allowing ice formation on surfaces and infrastructure. Such conditions in Central Texas are typically associated with strong Arctic fronts and rapid temperature drops.

Regional Climate Characteristics

Austin has a humid subtropical climate with generally mild winters, though periodic cold outbreaks occur.

- Winters are typically mild, but below-freezing temperatures occur about 25 days per year on average. (Source)
- At Camp Mabry, sub-freezing temperatures occur about 12 days annually, while Austin-Bergstrom Airport averages about 33 days. (Source)
- Strong northerly winds associated with winter cold fronts can cause rapid temperature drops and sudden freezes. (Source)
- Typical winter minimum temperatures in Austin during January–February average in the mid-30s °F, with occasional records significantly lower. (Source)

These characteristics indicate winter weather is infrequent but operationally significant when it occurs.

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Historical Temperature Extremes

- The coldest temperature ever recorded in Austin is −2°F on January 31, 1949. (Source)
- During the historic Great Blizzard of 1899, Austin recorded −1°F, among the lowest February temperatures observed in Texas.

These rare extremes demonstrate that even regions with mild winters can experience severe Arctic outbreaks.

Freeze Frequency and Seasonality

- The average first freeze occurs near early December and last freeze near mid-February.
- Frost risk typically begins by mid-November based on NOAA climate data normals.

Notable Winter Events

February 2021 Winter Storm

A major Arctic outbreak affected Central Texas and much of the state.

- Climate stations recorded 5–6 consecutive days of temperature records and multiple days of record snowfall across South-Central Texas.
- Austin itself received more than six inches of snow during that event, and impacts were widespread due to prolonged cold and infrastructure strain. (Source)
- During that same cold snap, Austin temperatures remained at or below freezing for about seven consecutive days.

This event is widely considered a planning benchmark because of the cascading impacts across power, water, transportation, and public safety systems. NOAA reports characterize Winter Storm Uri as one of the most significant cold weather events in Texas history, with winter conditions extending statewide and placing all Texas counties under Winter Storm Warnings. (Source)

Historical Freeze Records

- The latest freeze on record in Austin occurred April 9, 1914, when temperatures reached 32°F. (Source)

Such late-season freezes can significantly affect agriculture, vegetation, and outdoor infrastructure.

Hazard Characteristics for Austin

Winter weather hazards in Austin differ from those in northern climates:

- Events are rare but can produce disproportionately large impacts.
- Ice is often more hazardous than snow because it forms quickly and creates widespread transportation hazards.

Systemic Risk Characteristics

Winter storms typically affect regions simultaneously rather than locally. As a result:

- Entire communities and infrastructure systems may be impacted at once.
- Cascading failures are possible (transportation → utilities → healthcare → supply chains).
- Mapping specific risk zones is less effective than regional preparedness planning.

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Climate Trends and Future Risk

Government climate assessments project that:

- Freeze days in Austin may decrease 2–3× by late century under high-emissions scenarios.
- Multi-day hard freezes (mean daily temperature <28°F) will remain rare but still possible. (Source)

This indicates winter weather will remain a low-frequency, high-consequence hazard rather than disappearing entirely.

Situations

Certain areas within the county present heightened challenges for transportation, emergency response, and continuity of operations during winter weather events. These challenges are driven by limited cold-weather infrastructure, topographic features, elevated roadways, and dependencies on above-ground utilities. Winter weather hazards—particularly freezing rain, sleet, and prolonged freezing temperatures—can rapidly degrade roadway conditions, disrupt power and water systems, and restrict access for emergency responders. These vulnerabilities have been identified through historical winter storm impacts, infrastructure assessments, and after-action reviews of prior cold weather events affecting the City of Austin.

Critical Transportation Infrastructure

Bridges, overpasses, elevated roadways, and shaded corridors are particularly susceptible to ice formation during freezing rain and hard freeze events. These locations often become hazardous before surrounding surface streets, increasing the likelihood of traffic accidents and roadway closures. Reduced traction, limited treatment capability, and rapid icing can impede emergency response times and complicate evacuation or access to medical facilities and critical services.

Utility and Infrastructure Vulnerabilities

Winter weather events pose a significant threat to utility systems, particularly when freezing temperatures persist for extended periods. Ice accumulation and high winds can damage overhead power lines and substations, resulting in localized or widespread outages affecting residential areas, critical facilities, and warming centers. Freezing temperatures also increase the risk of water main breaks, frozen service lines, and pressure loss within the distribution system. Coordination with utility partners, including Austin Energy and Austin Water, is essential to mitigate cascading impacts and support restoration efforts.

Cold Weather Building and Infrastructure Considerations

Winter weather resilience in Austin/Travis County is limited by infrastructure not designed for frequent or prolonged freezing conditions. Many residential and commercial structures lack adequate insulation, pipe protection, or redundant heating systems. Prolonged hard freeze events increase the risk of structural damage, water intrusion following pipe failures, and displacement of residents due to loss of heat or water service.

Limited Access and High-Risk Areas

Certain neighborhoods and facilities are more vulnerable during winter weather events due to limited roadway access, reliance on bridges or elevated routes, or geographic isolation. Areas with a single primary access route, steep grades, or limited alternative pathways may become temporarily inaccessible due to ice



accumulation or road closures. These conditions complicate emergency response, delay service delivery, and may isolate residents during prolonged events.

Critical Facilities and Vulnerable Populations

Winter weather hazards disproportionately impact vulnerable populations, including individuals experiencing homelessness, older adults, medically fragile individuals, and those without reliable heating. Access to warming centers, medical care, and essential services may be constrained by hazardous travel conditions. Power outages and water service disruptions further increase risk to life safety and necessitate coordinated sheltering, transportation, and outreach operations.

Interagency Coordination and Operational Impacts

Winter weather events place simultaneous demands on transportation, utilities, public safety, health services, and emergency management functions. Reduced staffing availability, hazardous travel conditions, and competing response priorities can strain resources across departments. Pre-identified vulnerabilities, access constraints, and infrastructure risks must be incorporated into planning assumptions to support timely decision-making, resource allocation, and public messaging during winter weather incidents.

Community Assistance and Human Services Considerations

Residents affected by disasters may experience financial hardship due to increased utility usage, damaged housing, or loss of income. The City of Austin and the State of Texas offer programs that can help eligible households reduce utility costs and improve home energy efficiency.

- The City of Austin Utilities Customer Assistance Program (CAP) provides utility bill discounts for qualifying low- and fixed-income households, reducing annual utility costs through discounts on electric, water, wastewater, and drainage services. Emergency utility payment assistance may also be available through the Plus 1 Program. Link
- The Texas Department of Housing and Community Affairs (TDHCA) Weatherization Assistance Program (WAP) helps eligible low-income households' lower energy costs through energy-efficiency improvements such as insulation, weather sealing, and other home weatherization measures. The program is intended to reduce long-term energy burdens and increase housing resilience. Link

Assumptions

Emergency Operations Center (EOC) Activation

During a significant winter weather event—including freezing rain, sleet, snow, or prolonged hard freeze conditions—the City of Austin and Travis County may experience widespread transportation disruptions, utility failures, and increased life-safety risks. In such an event, the Emergency Operations Center (EOC) may be activated to coordinate interdepartmental operations, support resource allocation, and manage public information.

EOC activation may be triggered by issuance of National Weather Service Winter Storm Watches or Warnings, forecasted ice accumulation, extended subfreezing temperatures, or observed impacts exceeding routine departmental capacity. A local disaster declaration may be issued to facilitate emergency protective measures, emergency procurement, shelter operations, and access to state or federal assistance.

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Protective Actions and Public Safety Measures

Protective actions during winter weather events may include roadway closures, suspension or modification of public transit services, opening of warming centers, public messaging regarding travel restrictions, and implementation of cold weather sheltering (CWS) operations for vulnerable populations.

Winter weather protective actions are typically mobility-restrictive rather than mobility-enhancing. Residents may be advised to remain in place ("shelter-in-place") to reduce travel-related incidents. However, evacuations may become necessary if prolonged power outages, water system failures, or structural hazards render residential areas unsafe. Public safety agencies will determine protective action areas and implement advisories, closures, or operational modifications as conditions evolve.

Critical Infrastructure Impacts

Winter weather events have the potential to impact critical infrastructure, including electrical systems, water and wastewater facilities, communications networks, and transportation corridors. Ice accumulation on overhead lines may result in localized or widespread outages affecting residential areas, hospitals, warming centers, and public safety facilities.

Extended freezing temperatures may cause water main breaks, frozen service lines, pressure loss within the distribution system, and damage to facility infrastructure. Traffic signal outages due to power loss may increase crash risk and impede emergency response. These vulnerabilities should be identified, mitigated, and monitored before and during winter weather events to minimize cascading impacts and support continuity of operations.

Transportation System Disruption

It is assumed that bridges, overpasses, elevated roadways, and shaded corridors will become hazardous earlier than adjacent surface streets during freezing precipitation or hard freeze conditions. Roadway treatment capacity may be limited relative to the geographic scale of impacts. Traffic collisions, stalled vehicles, and road closures may significantly reduce mobility across the city and county. Emergency response times may increase due to hazardous travel conditions. Limited-access neighborhoods and areas dependent on elevated infrastructure may experience temporary isolation.

Utility Coordination and Restoration

Coordination with utility partners, including Austin Energy and Austin Water, will be essential during winter weather incidents. Restoration operations may be complicated by hazardous road conditions, resource limitations, and simultaneous service demands. It is assumed that prolonged freezing temperatures increase the likelihood of infrastructure failure, and restoration timelines may extend beyond the duration of the precipitation event.

Vulnerable Populations

Winter weather events disproportionately impact individuals experiencing homelessness, older adults, medically fragile individuals, and residents without reliable heating. Demand for warming centers, transportation assistance, and welfare checks may increase significantly. It is assumed that extended power outages or water disruptions will increase life-safety risks and may require expanded sheltering operations and coordinated outreach efforts.

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Concept of Operations

The following strategy has been developed by the participating agencies that are involved in winter weather response:

- Each participating agency will monitor potential weather conditions and will notify other agencies when conditions are warranted.
- Coordination among agencies will be handled at the City of Austin-Travis County Emergency Operations Center (EOC). Each agency shown on the notification sequence will send a representative to the EOC when it is activated. Prior to the EOC being activated, the City of Austin and Travis County may coordinate pre-incident situational awareness messages and meetings. Virtual options for coordination may be taken into consideration depending on the response.
- Once activated, each agency will advise the EOC, through their representative, of all winter related impacts like road closures, power outages, reduction in services, and other major incidents. Agencies will notify the EOC when winter related impacts have ended, or services restored like roads are reopened.
- The EOC will disseminate information regarding road closures as appropriate.
- Every attempt will be made to coordinate any modification of hours between major government entities and school districts. Modification of hours includes early closing, late opening, or closure for the day. The primary method for coordination of closure will be through a conference call established through the Austin-Travis County EOC. The conference call will include decision makers from the City of Austin, Travis County, University of Texas (UT), Austin Independent School District (AISD), Austin Community College (ACC), and other school districts or governmental entities as deemed appropriate. School closures place a burden on healthcare facilities and critical infrastructure employees who have children but need to report to work.
- The use of the Austin Warning and Communications System (AWACS) city/county all-call page will be considered for the dissemination of government closures or delayed openings. This would include, but not necessarily be limited to, the City of Austin, Travis County, AISD, ACC, and the University of Texas. Consideration will be given to the use of AWACS for reporting changes to events with more than 25,000 individuals (including event staff).
- The EOC will not attempt to disseminate individual schools (private and smaller public districts) and event closures (less than 25,000 in attendance) to the media. That should be done directly by the district involved.
- The EOC will work with departments to pre-position resources such as mission ready sheltering packages before the incident.

EOC Activation

During the pre-event and initial stages of any potential winter weather event, the Austin AEM Duty Officer will serve as the focal point for the communication of weather and operational information as it relates to winter weather operations. Winter weather incidents will generally be managed through the Austin/Travis County Emergency Operations Center utilizing Emergency Support Function (ESF) coordination. Field operations will remain under the authority of the responsible agencies and departments. Incident Command may be established for specific tactical incidents requiring on-scene management. Area Command may be considered during exceptionally complex winter weather events involving multiple Incident Command organizations operating simultaneously across multiple jurisdictions or operational areas.

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Alert/Initial Briefing

Austin Emergency Management will initiate notifications to city/county departments and partner agencies and schedule an initial incident briefing. The National Weather Service will issue the following advisories, watches and warnings:

Winter Weather Advisory (8–24-hour lead time)
Snow and/or sleet and ice accumulations causing an inconvenience to society and commerce are imminent or occurring.

Cold Weather Advisory (8–24-hour lead time)
Cold temperatures and brisk wind causing hazardous wind chills are imminent or occurring. Hypothermia and frost bite are possible if proper precautions are not taken.

Freezing Rain Advisory (8–24-hour lead time)
Ice accumulation less than 1/4 inch within 12 hours due to freezing rain is imminent or occurring.

Frost Advisory (8–24-hour lead time)
A Frost Advisory is issued when the minimum temperature is forecast to be 33 to 36 degrees on clear and calm nights.

Winter Storm Watch (12–48-hour lead time)
Possibility of accumulating snow, sleet, and/or freezing rain causing severe impacts to society and commerce.

Winter Chill Watch (12–48-hour lead time)
Possibility of very cold temperatures and brisk winds causing dangerously cold wind chills.

Freeze Watch (12–48-hour lead time)
A Freeze Watch is issued when there is a potential for significant, widespread freezing temperatures within the next 24-36 hours.

Blizzard Watch (12–48-hour lead time)
Possibility of sustained winds or wind gusts above 35 mph causing falling and/or blowing snow to reduce visibilities below 1/4 mile for 3 hours or longer.

Winter Storm Warning (8–36-hour lead time)
Heavy snow and/or sleet and ice accumulations are imminent or occurring. Society and commerce are expected to be greatly impacted. Precipitation may be accompanied by gusty wind.

Extreme Cold Warning (8–36-hour lead time)
Very cold air temperatures and brisk wind causing dangerously cold wind chills is imminent or occurring. Hypothermia, frost bite or death is likely if proper precautions are not taken.



Ice Storm Warning (8–36-hour lead time)
Heavy ice accumulations of 1/4 inch or greater within 12 hours due to freezing rain are imminent or occurring.

Freeze Warning (8–36-hour lead time)
A Freeze Warning is issued when significant, widespread freezing temperatures are expected.

Blizzard Warning (8–36-hour lead time)
Sustained winds or frequent gusts above 35mph causing falling and/or blowing snow to reduce visibilities below 1/4 mile for 3 hours or longer is imminent or occurring.

The National Weather Service Local Winter Weather Probabilities site is utilized as a decision-support tool to inform situational awareness and operational planning for winter weather events, providing probabilistic forecasts and impact-based guidance.

Operational Periods and Situational Reports

Operational periods will be determined at the discretion of the EOC Director; Situational reports will be requested prior to the end of each operational period.

Situational Awareness and Coordination

Austin Emergency Management and Travis County Office of Emergency Management will coordinate EOC briefings and communicate goals and objectives for each operational period. NWS will provide periodic updates and maintain weather products; Austin Emergency Management and Travis County Office of Emergency Management TPW will disseminate this information through the proper channels.

Coordination of Initial Operations

The AEM Duty Officer and the Travis County Office of Emergency Management Duty Officer are the respective points of contact for coordinating information about weather forecasts, disruption of operations, and initial roadway surface treatment operations performed by area agencies. Participating agencies should notify the AEM Duty Officer (City departments, and organizations within City of Austin) or Travis County Duty Officer (County departments, and organizations outside of the City of Austin) for any of the following conditions:

- The Texas Department of Transportation (TXDOT) reports on winter weather operations and preparedness in response to impending ice or snow moving toward Travis County.
- National Weather Service (NWS) or Lower Colorado River Authority (LCRA) reports an impending storm.
- Any agency receives requests for surface treatment from field units.
- Surface treatment crews are mobilized by TXDOT, Travis County, or the City of Austin within the Travis County area.

Duty Officers notify their respective counterparts with the City or County when roadway treatment operations begin:

- TxDOT
- City of Austin Transportation and Public Works-Street and Bridge Operations



- Travis County Transportation and Natural Resources

Activation Triggers

Activation of the EOC for winter weather events will be coordinated through the AEM Director and TCOEM Emergency Management Coordinator. Austin AEM and Travis County Office of Emergency Management (TCOEM) will assess and monitor the situation. When practical, participating in City, County, and State agencies will be consulted prior to issuing an activation notice. For the safety of EOC responders, when possible, the EOC will be activated prior to the onset of winter precipitation in Travis County. Any activation could include the agencies and entities found in Appendix 3 – Winter Weather EOC Agencies.

Role of the EOC

The Austin-Travis County EOC will serve as the location for coordination of all Austin and Travis County government activities related to winter storm operations. This includes, but is not limited to, the following:

- Ensure operation of critical governmental operations, including public safety and utility crews.
- Facilitate situational awareness conference calls.
- Coordinate road surface treatment operations within Travis County.
- Coordinate the decision making on the closing and opening of publicly maintained roads.
- Collect and assess information including weather reports, observed conditions, and damage reports.
- Assess the impact of storms on community safety and governmental operations.
- Coordination for the decision to modify the hours of operation for the City of Austin, Travis County, University of Texas, AISD, ACC, and other key stakeholders.
- Coordination of mass care and sheltering and warming centers.
- Coordinate impact to Cold Weather Shelter (CWS) operations if activated.
- Coordinate the release of public information.
- Coordinate recovery planning upon EOC activation.

Regional Coordination

Winter weather incidents frequently produce impacts that extend beyond jurisdictional boundaries and affect communities throughout Central Texas simultaneously. Because severe winter weather can impact transportation networks, utility systems, critical infrastructure, and vulnerable populations across multiple counties, coordinated regional response efforts are essential.

The City of Austin and Travis County will maintain close coordination with neighboring jurisdictions, including Hays County and Williamson County, to support a unified regional response and recovery effort. Coordination may occur through established emergency management channels, regional coordination calls, Emergency Operations Centers (EOCs), the Capital Area Council of Governments (CAPCOG), the Texas Division of Emergency Management (TDEM), and other partner agencies as appropriate.

Regional coordination activities may include:

- Sharing situational awareness information, weather forecasts, damage assessments, and operational priorities.
- Coordinating roadway treatment operations, closures, detours, and public messaging across jurisdictional boundaries.
- Exchanging information regarding shelter and warming center availability, capacity, and access requirements.



- Coordinating resource requests and mutual aid support through local, regional, and state resource management systems.
- Sharing information on utility outages, restoration priorities, and impacts to critical infrastructure.
- Coordinating public information messaging to provide consistent and timely information to residents throughout the region.
- Identifying regional impacts to healthcare facilities, long-term care facilities, schools, and other critical services.
- Coordinating transportation and access issues affecting commuters and travelers moving between Travis, Hays, and Williamson Counties.
- Supporting regional planning for commodity distribution, emergency protective measures, and recovery operations during prolonged outages or infrastructure disruptions.

During widespread winter weather events, Austin/Travis County may participate in regional coordination calls with Hays County, Williamson County, TDEM, utility providers, transportation agencies, and other stakeholders to establish a common operating picture and identify resource shortfalls requiring state assistance. When local and regional resources become strained, requests for assistance may be submitted through TDEM in accordance with established emergency management procedures.

Outreach to Vulnerable Populations

Individuals experiencing homelessness are among the populations most vulnerable to winter weather hazards due to prolonged exposure to freezing temperatures, limited access to shelter, and increased risk of cold-related illness or death. As winter weather conditions are forecast, the City of Austin Homeless Strategy Office (HSO) will coordinate with Austin Emergency Management (AEM), nonprofit service providers, faith-based organizations, and regional partners to conduct proactive outreach and connect individuals to available services and shelter resources.

Prior to anticipated freezing temperatures, HSO may:

- Coordinate enhanced outreach operations to areas known to have unsheltered populations.
- Disseminate information regarding anticipated weather conditions, warming center locations, shelter availability, transportation options, and cold weather safety measures.
- Coordinate with service providers to encourage voluntary relocation to shelters, warming centers, or other safe indoor facilities.
- Support transportation efforts for individuals seeking access to warming centers or emergency shelter.
- Coordinate the distribution of cold-weather supplies such as blankets, cold-weather clothing, hand warmers, and other protective items as available.
- Maintain situational awareness regarding shelter capacity and communicate resource needs to the Emergency Operations Center (EOC) when activated.
- Coordinate with healthcare, behavioral health, and social service partners to identify individuals with elevated medical or functional needs who may require additional assistance during extreme cold events.

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During prolonged winter weather incidents, HSO will continue coordination with shelter operators, outreach teams, and community partners to identify service gaps, monitor impacts to vulnerable populations, and support continuity of care for individuals experiencing homelessness.

When Cold Weather Shelter activation criteria are met, HSO will coordinate with Austin Emergency Management, and community partners to support shelter operations, public messaging, and transportation assistance for individuals seeking refuge from hazardous winter weather conditions.

Closure Procedures

Coordination in the Closure or Modification of Government Facilities or Services

The Austin-Travis County EOC representatives will coordinate with executives for the City of Austin, Travis County, AISD, UT, and ACC to discuss and, when possible, reach a consensus on modification of service hours for government facilities. This information will also be available to other school districts and stakeholders for their internal decision-making.

Key decision makers will typically coordinate actions for the upcoming business day during one or more conferences calls through the EOC. This allows for the decision to be released to employees and the public before they begin their trips to work or school.

Similarly, calls will be held to discuss and coordinate the need for early closures if severe weather threatens during the day.

It must be understood that weather forecasting in Central Texas is an art and a science. At best, forecasts may be uncertain. In some cases, it may be appropriate to delay facility opening in the morning, to allow more time to assess actual weather conditions. This can then be followed with later announcements of closures or "business as usual."

An example of a typical battle rhythm schedule is included in Appendix 2.

Any conference call should include key stakeholders and a meteorologist.

- The Austin City Manager makes the final decision on closures for City facilities.
- The Travis County Judge makes the final decision on closures for County facilities.
- Chief Executives from other governments, schools, and organizations make the final decision on closure of their respective facilities.

Coordination of School Closures or Modification of School Hours

The City of Austin and Travis County have worked closely with the Central Texas School Safety Consortium (School Consortium), The University of Texas, Austin Community College, and various higher education institutions to develop a system for coordinating the closure of schools or the modification of school hours.

The Austin Independent School District will coordinate with local School Superintendents and the School Safety Consortium to assess their status and concerns. AISD will serve as the primary spokesperson for all K-12 schools on the conference calls. Other school districts are welcome to monitor the calls to assist them in their internal decision-making.



Each institution makes its own determination regarding closure. However, to simplify the message to the public, facilities are either "Closed" for the entire day, openings are "Delayed", or there is an "Early Release". Due to transportation and logistical issues, facilities close for the entire day if they are unable to open according to the following system:

- When delayed, higher education facilities open for classes at or after approximately 10 a.m. Each institution sets its own specific time to meet its class timetable for that day.
- When delayed, independent school districts and other similar institutions usually open after a 2-hour delay. This allows schools, which normally operate on a staggered opening schedule, to provide clear guidance to parents.

In some situations, schools may elect to cancel all after-school or evening activities. In other cases, a specific event, such as a concert or athletic match, may be cancelled. In these cases, the cancellation announcement should be made in the clearest and simple terms possible.

Treatment Strategies

For all areas inside Travis County, the EOC will manage and triage surface treatment requests for all roadways maintained by the City of Austin, Travis County, and TXDOT. Focus will be placed upon keeping major arteries and highways open. Reasonable efforts will be made to meet surface treatment requests forwarded from other departments and agencies when resources are available.

Management of Surface Treatment Requests

Surface treatment requests, regardless of jurisdiction, will be coordinated through the EOC whenever it is activated. Agencies or organizations with a request for surface treatment of streets or other areas will forward those requests to their representative in the EOC. That agency representative will be responsible for input of the request to WebEOC (i.e., active WebEOC Incident via Resource Requests) and subsequent follow-up with the original requestor. Agencies that do not have representation at the EOC may call in requests through the main EOC number at [redacted] some departments may also use 311 to make requests.

In certain situations, agencies may allow remote locations (such as public safety dispatch centers) to input requests. Remote input requests require the approval of that agency's EOC representative and the EOC Director.

City of Austin Transportation and Public Works Strategy

Austin Transportation and Public Works Department's (ATPW) Street and Bridge Operations (SBO) is responsible for applying surface treatments (within available resources) to lessen the impacts of ice and snow on City streets that are not Federal, State, or County roadways. SBO manages roughly 8,000 lane-miles of roadway. Given this number of lane-miles, incoming surface treatment requests from various entities, the need to reapply treatments, and limited resources, SBO can manage treating about 400 lane-miles or one lane in each direction for about 200 miles.

ATPW outlines resources and strategies to achieve this mileage and priority roadways in their Winter Weather Response Plan (Appendix 6). Each event is different, and conditions may dictate a different prioritization to meet mobility needs. It is important to mention that the event severity can hamper SBO's ability to address ice and snow treatment needs.



Surface Treatment Requests for City of Austin Controlled Roadways

When the EOC is activated, all requests from City departments for the treatment of City controlled streets and facilities should be directed through WebEOC resource requests and to the respective department's EOC representative. Departments or organizations that do not have a representative at the EOC should call the main EOC number at ([redacted] 311 can also be used by city agencies to make requests. Reasonable efforts will be made to meet surface treatment requests forwarded from other departments and agencies.

The City of Austin will not accept surface treatment requests from the general public; however, the public is encouraged to report any hazardous street conditions to 3-1-1. Call takers should treat such calls as a traffic hazard. Due to resource limitations, residential streets typically will not be treated. ATPW SBO crews cannot treat private property or privately owned streets. Examples include parking lots and streets inside of apartment complexes or industrial parks.

Pre-Treatment of Critical Facilities

ATPW SBOs will attempt to pre-treat access to identified city/county-owned facilities that contain emergency service units or equipment necessary to maintain critical infrastructure upon request. City/County departments and agencies are generally responsible for their own facilities including maintaining access. Individual departments should forward pre-treatment requests to the AEM Duty Officer or to the EOC if activated using a method established by the EOC (i.e., appropriate WebEOC Incident via a Resource Request).

Upon request through the EOC, the City of Austin and Travis County will attempt to provide surface treatment as practical to non-City of Austin/Travis County owned facilities such as hospitals, schools and private facilities that are routinely accessed by City and County personnel engaged in critical operations.

Requests for the utilization of TXDOT manpower and materials in support of local needs must be made through the Texas Department of Public Safety (DPS) Disaster District Chairman via the Austin-Travis County EOC.

Travis County Transportation and Natural Resources Strategy

Travis County Transportation and Natural Resources (TNR) is responsible for treatment of Travis County roadways and bridges that have been accepted for maintenance in the unincorporated areas not maintained by TXDOT or other municipalities within Travis County.

Surface Treatment Requests for TNR

When the EOC is activated, requests from government agencies and EOC partner agencies for treatment of Travis County roadways or structures should be directed through WebEOC resource requests and to the TNR EOC representative.

Requests from non-government agencies and EOC partners should be routed through email or by telephone.

TNR Dispatch: tnr.dispatch@traviscountytx.gov / (512) 854-9433

Alternatively, Travis County Sheriff's Office and be contacted to request road treatments.

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Travis County TNR has developed the Road and Bridge Ice and Snow Plan which details levels of service and priority roads. TNR will follow such plan that identifies resources including materials, equipment, and personnel which are staged at the West Service Center (WSC) or East Service Center (ESC) for response.

TXDOT Austin Region Strategy

TXDOT has the responsibility for treatment of primary highways, State roads, and Interstate Highway-35. Priority will be given to the treatment of freeways and elevated sections of highways. Overall priorities for TXDOT treatment operations will be to keep roadways open as long as possible. TXDOT maintains a special snow and ice control plan. When activated, the TXDOT Austin District EOC can be reached at [redacted] or [redacted]

Use of Chemicals

Agencies will treat roadways with salt, magnesium chloride, calcium chloride, and may apply these with or without a mix of aggregate. Surfaces treated with magnesium chloride can have a sheen which can be mistaken for an icy surface. It is important to not shut down or restrict traffic based upon appearance of treated surfaces since the road may still appear icy after magnesium chloride is applied.

Surface Treatment Requests for TXDOT Controlled Roadways

All treatment requests for TXDOT controlled highways should be forwarded to the requesting department's EOC representative. If there is no department EOC representative, then agencies may call in requests to Combined Transportation, Emergency and Communications Center (CTECC) TXDOT Operations Supervisor at (512) 974-0883.

Strategy for Elevated Highway Sections (Flyovers)

TXDOT will give priority to the treatment of elevated sections of major highways including the upper decks of Interstate Highway 35, Ben White Blvd., and U.S. Highway 183 North. Every effort should be made to keep elevated portions open as traffic and the salt help prevent and melt ice. Law enforcement and public safety field personnel should coordinate mobility issues related to elevated sections with their EOC representatives. Public Safety EOC representatives will then work with TXDOT's EOC representatives to ensure priority treatment of all elevated highway sections.

Use of TXDOT Highway Signs

Use of TXDOT controlled highway message boards and signs should be considered whenever appropriate. Requests for use of the signs should include the wording of the information to be displayed. Requests for use should be directed to the following personnel, in the following order:

- TxDOT EOC Representative (if the EOC is activated).
- CTECC TXDOT Operations Supervisor.
- AEM Duty Officer.

ATPW maintains several smaller digital messaging signs on select arterial roadways that can be used to provide messaging.

TNR maintains several smaller digital messaging signs on select arterial roadways that can be used to provide messaging.



Other Operational Considerations

Outage Management of Critical Facilities and Customers

In cases where winter storm conditions cause power failures or rotating outages the EOC will coordinate activities to support individuals or services where the interruption of power represents a life-threatening or safety issue.

Community members who use medical equipment that requires electrical power should have a back-up source that can be used during a power failure. Austin Energy maintains the Medically Vulnerable Registry with information about community members who require electricity for medical devices, etc. Consideration may be given to opening a shelter for persons dependent on electrical equipment. The decision for opening a shelter will be based upon recommendations from key medical stakeholders at the EOC. Priority will be based on restoration of power, temporary solutions, and evacuation as a last resort.

City and County departments along with EOC hospital representatives and the CATRAC 7-RMOC will report critical facilities experiencing utility outages to the Austin Energy utility representative in the EOC.

Additionally, Pedernales Electric and Bluebonnet Electric provide services to Travis County. TCOEM will coordinate with their Emergency Response teams if needed.

Use of Chains on City of Austin Vehicles

Departments are expected to have tire traction devices to provide their respective services as needed during an ice/snow event. The City of Austin Fleet Mobility Services (FMSD) operating procedure for snow chain purchase, inventory, installation, and removal is as follows.

Department Responsibility:
The user department shall be responsible for budgeting and for purchase enhancing traction devices (snow chains).
The user department shall be responsible for the storage, tracking and arrangement with FMSD for training on installation of the traction enhancing devices (tire chains/cables).
The user department shall be responsible for providing FMSD with the following each year in October:

- Identification of winter storm response units, traction devices to be used.
- Confirmation of devices on hand, any training needed.
- Traction Enhancing Device (Snow Chain) will be stored on the fleet asset (unit) if possible. If not possible the traction enhancing device (Snow Chain) will be stored in a user department-controlled inventory location

Fleet Mobility Services Responsibility:

- FMSD shall maintain contractual, vendor and purchasing responsibilities.
- FMSD shall act as advisor and make recommendations on appropriate traction device to be purchased. FMSD will contact departments each year during the months of October-November to confirm that departments have established resources.
- FMSD shall provide training to user departments on the installation and de-installation of traction enhancing devices if needed (snow chains/cables).
- FMSD will assist AFD, ATCEMS, APD as needed per user department Special Order or SOP's outlined for tire chains use.

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Snow Chain Installation:

- Upon request from the department, FMSD will assist with installation of the traction enhancing device if needed.
- If the request is during normal Service Center operating hours, the user department is to contact their assigned service location to schedule the installation.
- If the request is after hours, weekends or during City closures, a request via phone call to the after-hours Fleet Emergency number ([redacted] should be made.

Vehicle Safety, Operation and Maintenance with Snow Chains:

- Tire chain/cable operating requirements vary by manufacture. Devices shall be operated and maintained in accordance with the specific manufacture of the devices.
- Snow Chain Removal:
- Upon request from the department, once it is deemed that the traction enhancing devices are no longer needed, the user department is to contact their assigned Service Center location to schedule the removal.
- If the request is during normal Service Center operating hours, the user department is to contact their assigned service location to schedule the de-installation.

If the request is after hours, weekends or during City closures, a request via phone call to the after-hours Fleet Emergency number ([redacted] should be made.

Sheltering

The City of Austin and Travis County have situational dependent sheltering plans. Plans will be referenced according to need.

Cold Weather Shelters (CWS)

Cold weather shelters are available for city residents once conditions are approaching a pre-determined threshold thus resulting in the CWS activating. At that time, public facilities are identified to augment Austin Homeless Strategies Office (HSO) operations and serve as cold weather shelters.

Emergency Public Transportation Service

Some winter storm events may require Capital Metro (CapMetro) to modify normal bus, paratransit, and rail operations. CapMetro will modify its service based upon available resources and road/rail conditions. Modifications may include limiting service hours, reducing service frequency, or running only certain routes. If ice is present or anticipated, CapMetro may modify routes to avoid bridges, overpasses, and flyovers. If conditions are severe and operator and public safety is a concern, CapMetro may suspend bus and paratransit service entirely.

In the event of a service suspension, CapMetro will endeavour to have a limited number of buses and paratransit vehicles available as an emergency fleet. This fleet will support life sustaining trips for Metro Access customers and provide emergency transportation as directed by the EOC.

When weather conditions require modification of operations beyond the avoidance of overpasses, Capital Metro will inform the AEM Duty Officer of the decision. This contact may take place in the EOC, should it be activated, through the Capital Metro representative.



Command and Coordination

Incident Command Structure (ICS)

The Austin Emergency Management Director, or designee, will manage the Emergency Operations Center (EOC) and provide coordinated support to Incident Command throughout the incident. AEM declares the EOC activation level based on conditions and forecasts, coordinates EOC briefings, and communicates goals and objectives that support on-scene command for each operational period.

Using available threat and hazard information, Incident Command will initiate protective action measures. Evacuation decisions and should follow procedures outlined in the Functional Annex: All-Hazards Protective Action Plan.

Incident Priorities

1. Life Safety: Protecting the public, responders, and vulnerable populations (e.g., unhoused individuals, medically dependent persons, elderly residents) is the highest priority. Actions include sheltering, warming operations, medical support, traffic incident response, and public warning.
2. Incident Stabilization: Stabilizing winter weather impacts by maintaining situational awareness, coordinating multi-agency response, restoring critical lifelines (power, transportation, communications, water), and preventing secondary incidents such as crashes, fires, or carbon monoxide exposure.
3. Property and Environmental Conservation: Protecting homes, businesses, and critical infrastructure systems from damage caused by freezing temperatures, ice accumulation, snow load, and utility disruptions. Emphasis includes infrastructure protection, burst pipe prevention, and continuity of essential services.
4. Societal Restoration: Supporting rapid recovery and return to normal operations through debris/ice removal, utility restoration, reopening transportation networks, and resumption of government, healthcare, education, and commerce functions.

Roles and Responsibilities Per Emergency Support Functions

Emergency Support Function 1 – Transportation

Austin Transportation and Public Works

- Supports coordination of traffic management operations during winter weather conditions, including roadway monitoring, closure implementation, and detour routing.
- Deploys and maintain traffic control devices, minimal barricades, signage, and signal systems to support safe travel and incident scene protection during icy or hazardous road conditions to assist APD.
- Prioritize treatment and access for critical transportation corridors, including emergency routes, hospital access routes bridges, and elevated roadways.
- Supports post-incident damage assessments and safety inspections of transportation infrastructure affected by freezing temperatures, ice accumulation, or storm impacts.
- Provides trained personnel to assist with field assessments, route clearance coordination, and operational support as requested.

Austin Fleet Mobility Services

- Provides transportation fleet support for City personnel conducting winter weather response and recovery operations.



- Coordinates vehicle readiness, maintenance, and deployment of specialized vehicles (e.g., utility trucks, transport vans, response vehicles).
- Supports logistics operations by ensuring availability of fuel, maintenance support, and fleet staging for extended operational periods.
- Assists with resource mobilization and transportation support for interdepartmental response activities.

CapMetro

- Assist with Transportation Unit Officer duties in the Incident Command Post and/or Emergency Operations Center
- Provide transportation logistical support in support of evacuation operations
- Coordinates service modifications, route suspensions, or emergency transit operations based on roadway conditions and safety considerations
- Assists with transportation support for essential personnel and critical workforce movement when requested

Travis County Transportation and Natural Resources

- Coordinates winter weather transportation operations on county-maintained roadways, including monitoring conditions, coordinating treatment actions, and reporting hazards.
- Supports route clearance and debris removal on county infrastructure impacted by ice or storm-related conditions.
- Provides situational awareness updates to regional partners regarding roadway accessibility and operational constraints.
- Coordinates mutual aid and resource support with municipalities and state partners as required.

Texas Department of Transportation / Austin Highway Emergency Response Operator (HERO)

- Leads coordination of transportation operations on state highways and interstate systems within the operational area.
- Conducts roadway condition monitoring, hazard reporting, and coordination of treatment or closure operations during winter weather.
- Deploys HERO units to assist motorists, manage incidents, and support traffic flow during hazardous conditions.
- Coordinates with local jurisdictions to ensure consistent messaging, route prioritization, and traffic management across jurisdictional boundaries.

Emergency Support Function 2 – Communications

Greater Austin Travis Regional Radio System (GATTRS) Committee

- Provide a Communications Unit Leader (COML) to coordinate interoperability radio channels (ICS-205)
- Conduct channel deconfliction and ensure communications interoperability

Emergency Support Function 3 – Public Works and Engineering

Austin Transportation and Public Works

- Support restoration of community lifelines
- Lead coordination of roadway pretreatment and de-icing operations using appropriate treatment chemicals and materials, and prioritization of critical routes.



- Conducts road condition monitoring and communicates closures or hazards to EOC and public information channels
- Deploys crews for removal of fallen trees, debris, and ice-related obstructions impacting public rights-of-way.
- Assess structural impacts to bridges, overpasses, and elevated infrastructure susceptible to icing.

Austin Watershed Protection

- Support restoration of community lifelines
- Monitor stormwater systems for freezing, blockage, or overflow conditions
- Assists with flood risk monitoring during rapid thaw or rain-on scenarios
- Provides technical expertise regarding drainage system functionality and environmental impacts from winter precipitation

Austin Development Services

- Support restoration of community lifelines
- Supports post-incident damage assessments and safety inspections, and provides trained personnel to assist as needed

Austin Resource Recovery

- Support restoration of community lifelines
- Supports post-incident damage assessments and safety inspections, and provides trained personnel to assist as needed

Emergency Support Function 4 – Firefighting; Emergency Support Function 9 – Search and Rescue; Emergency Support Function 10 – Oil and Hazardous Materials; Emergency Support Function 21 – Emergency Medical Services

Austin Fire

- Serves as the lead agency for all-hazards emergency response to non-law enforcement incidents during winter weather, including structure fires, technical rescues, hazardous materials incidents, and weather-related emergencies.
- Provides primary response for cold-weather rescue operations, including vehicle extrications from ice-related crashes, ice/water rescues, and responses involving downed power lines or structural collapse caused by ice accumulation.
- Maintains operational readiness for urban search and rescue (USAR) missions involving trapped or stranded persons due to snow, ice, structural damage, or transportation disruptions.
- Coordinates evacuation operations when conditions require relocation due to infrastructure failure, unsafe housing, or life safety threats related to freezing temperatures or power outages.
- Supports damage assessment and safety inspection operations, including identification of unsafe structures, compromised utilities, and hazardous environmental conditions.
- Assists with public safety outreach and community risk reduction messaging related to heating safety, generator use, and fire prevention during cold weather.

Austin Travis County Emergency Medical Services

- Serves as the lead agency for prehospital medical response and medical coordination during winter weather incidents.
- Leads coordination of Transportation Assistance and Patient Support (TAPS) operations for medically vulnerable populations requiring transport to shelters, warming centers, or medical facilities.



- Responds to weather-related medical emergencies including hypothermia, frostbite, carbon monoxide poisoning, slips/falls, motor vehicle collisions, and cold-related exacerbations of chronic illness.
- Supports search and rescue operations by providing medical triage, treatment, and transport capabilities.
- Coordinates with hospitals, public health, and regional partners to monitor healthcare system impacts and maintain medical surge awareness.
- Assists with patient evacuation or relocation when healthcare facilities experience infrastructure disruption due to winter weather.

Emergency Support Function 5 – Emergency Management

Austin Emergency Management

- Coordinate and support response and recovery operations
- Manage and support information flow within the EOC
- Develop and provide operational objectives for the EOC
- Maintain documentation management within the EOC for the Incident
- Recommend local emergency or disaster declarations to the mayor

Emergency support Function 6 – Mass Care

Austin Emergency Management

- Coordinate and support mass care operations
- Lead and coordinate the Austin Resilience Network
- Lead sheltering operations.

Austin Public Health

- Assists coordinating sheltering operations.
- Supports post-incident damage assessments damage assessments and safety inspections, and provides trained personnel to assist as needed

Austin Parks and Recreation

- Identify departmental facilities suitable for shelters and MARC locations based on operational guidance

Austin Animal Services

- Provide pet and service animal sheltering and support

Emergency Support Function 8 – Public Health and Medical

Austin Public Health

- Coordinate outreach to STEAR participants and vulnerable populations
- Lead public health monitoring and epidemiological support

Capital Area Trauma Regional Advisory Council (CATRAC)

- Coordinate and support hospital and long-term care facility evacuations

Emergency Support Function 11 – Agriculture and Natural Resources

Austin Animal Services

- Lead coordination of pet and service animal evacuation and care operations

Travis County Transportation and Natural Resources

- Lead coordination of county road ice treatment and Right of Way (ROW)



Emergency Support Function 12 – Energy

Austin Energy

- Provides real-time power grid status updates, outage forecasting, and restoration prioritization to support situational awareness and EOC decision-making.
- Leads coordination of electric service restoration operations, prioritizing critical facilities, life-safety infrastructure, and community lifeline sectors (hospitals, water systems, public safety facilities, shelters, and emergency operations centers).
- Conducts load management and grid stabilization actions during periods of extreme demand or system stress caused by freezing temperatures.
- Supports planned de-energization or isolation of electrical infrastructure when required to protect responders, the public, and equipment during hazardous winter conditions such as downed lines or ice damage.
- Deploys crews to assess and repair damage caused by ice accumulation, wind, freezing rain, or equipment failure.
- Coordinates with regional transmission operators, utilities, and emergency management partners to support regional power reliability and mutual aid restoration efforts.
- Supports restoration of Energy and Communications Community Lifelines following winter weather impacts.
- Provides public information support related to outage safety, restoration timelines, conservation requests, and safe generator use.

Emergency Support Function 13 – Public Safety and Security

Austin Police

- Lead law enforcement operations and ensure public safety
- Coordinate public safety winter weather operations
- Establish and lead the Traffic Management Committee
- Provide perimeter and access control security

Emergency Support Function 15 – Public Information

Austin Emergency Management

- Serves as the lead agency for emergency public information coordination
- Manages the Joint Information System (JIS) and Joint Information Center (JIC) when required

Austin Communications and Engagement

- Authority to activate the JIS

Joint Information System (JIS)

- Serve as the primary public information and media relations lead for the City of Austin
- Manages public information distribution through media releases, City websites, social media, and press briefings
- Coordinates translation, accessibility, and outreach efforts to ensure equitable communication to all populations
- Supports the development of talking points, press releases, and visual information products
- Coordinates press releases/conferences with City departments, Travis County, and regional partners
- Develops and disseminates protective action guidance and emergency notifications to the public



- Coordinates emergency alerts and warnings through official channels (e.g., Warn Central Texas, Wireless Emergency Alerts, traditional and social media)
- Provides situation updates and key messages to the EOC and executive leadership
- Ensures information is accessible, accurate, and provided in multiple languages and accessible formats

Emergency Support Function 18 – Education

Education System

- Lead of protective actions on their campuses by the direction of school administration and/or public safety officials
- Responsible for communicating protective actions to parents, students, and City of Austin

WINTER WEATHER

Hazard-Specific Annex



Public Information

Alerts and Warnings

The community will be alerted through multiple communication channels to ensure timely and accurate information dissemination. These may include notifications from the National Weather Service (NWS) via NOAA Weather Radio, Warn Central Texas Alerts, Wireless Emergency Alerts (WEA), Integrated Public Alert and Warning System (IPAWS), in-person notifications by first responders, and updates through media outlets and other public information platforms. Residents are expected to take appropriate protective actions in response to these alerts

Winter Weather Preparedness and Protective Actions

Preparedness (Year-Round)

Residents, businesses, and visitors should take proactive measures to reduce vulnerability to winter weather hazards, including freezing temperatures, ice accumulation, power outages, and transportation disruptions.

- Register for emergency notifications through Warn Central Texas.
- Prepare an emergency supply kit ("Go-Bag") containing the 5 P's: People, Pets, Plastic (cash and credit cards), Papers (important documents), and Prescriptions.
- Maintain at least a three-day supply of food and water (one gallon per person per day).
- Store flashlights, batteries, and backup charging devices.
- Keep extra blankets, sleeping bags, and warm clothing readily available.
- Test smoke alarms and carbon monoxide detectors.
- Identify safe heating methods and never use grills, generators, ovens, or stovetops to heat indoor spaces.
- Maintain at least one-half tank of fuel in vehicles during winter months.
- Check vehicle tires, windshield wipers, and emergency supplies.
- Insulate exposed pipes and outdoor faucets.
- Learn how to shut off water service at the main valve.
- Identify nearby warming centers and community shelters.
- Check on elderly neighbors, individuals with access and functional needs, and medically fragile residents.
- Ensure pets and livestock have adequate shelter, food, and water.
- Learn about winter weather preparedness through trusted resources such as Ready Central Texas and the National Weather Service.

Utility Assistance and Home Weatherization Resources

Residents may reduce winter weather impacts through utility assistance and energy-efficiency programs designed to improve household resilience.

- The City of Austin Customer Assistance Program (CAP) provides utility bill discounts and assistance for eligible low- and fixed-income households.
- The Texas Weatherization Assistance Program (WAP) helps eligible households improve home energy efficiency through insulation, weather sealing, and other weatherization measures that reduce energy costs and improve indoor comfort during extreme temperatures.

Additional information is available through:

- City of Austin Utility Bill Discounts Program
- Texas Department of Housing and Community Affairs Weatherization Assistance Program

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WINTER WEATHER

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Actions Before a Winter Weather Event

When winter weather is forecast:

- Monitor National Weather Service forecasts and local emergency information.
- Stay informed on winter weather danger levels and expected conditions.
- Ensure family members and employees understand emergency and evacuation plans.
- Cover or drain irrigation systems.
- Open cabinet doors beneath sinks to allow warm air circulation around pipes.
- Drip indoor faucets to reduce the risk of frozen pipes.
- Bring pets indoors.
- Charge electronic devices, medical equipment, and backup batteries.
- Complete errands and obtain necessary supplies before precipitation begins.
- Avoid unnecessary travel.
- Identify alternate travel routes in case bridges or overpasses become impassable.
- Locate flashlights and emergency supplies.
- Adjust thermostats to maintain safe indoor temperatures.

Protective Actions During Winter Weather

During freezing conditions, ice events, or prolonged power outages:

- Follow instructions from emergency responders and local officials.
- Avoid travel unless absolutely necessary.
- Treat signalized intersections without power as four-way stops.
- Avoid walking on ice-covered surfaces.
- Use generators outdoors only and at least 20 feet from buildings.
- Keep space heaters away from combustible materials.
- Close off unused rooms to conserve heat.
- Wear layered clothing and use blankets to maintain body temperature.
- Move vulnerable household members to the warmest interior room.
- Monitor indoor temperatures; temperatures below 55°F increase the likelihood of frozen pipes.
- Continue checking on neighbors and vulnerable populations.

Water System and Utility Disruption Safety

If freezing temperatures damage water infrastructure:

- Shut off the water supply if a pipe bursts.
- Use stored water for drinking and sanitation needs.
- Follow all boil water notices and public health guidance issued by local authorities.

Winter Driving Safety

If travel cannot be avoided:

- Drive slowly and increase following distance.
- Avoid sudden braking, acceleration, or sharp turns.
- Watch for black ice, particularly on bridges, overpasses, and shaded roadways.
- Carry emergency supplies in vehicles, including blankets, water, food, flashlights, and phone chargers.

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WINTER WEATHER

Hazard-Specific Annex



BE SITUATIONALLY AWARE DURING DISASTERS

Official warnings may not always arrive in time. Community members should also be alert to natural indicators (e.g., ice forming, rapidly dropping temperature) and take protective action.

Information and Resources

The following tools may be used to gather and share information during events:

- NWS SLACK Tool (account required)
- NWS Winter Preparedness Winter Preparedness
- ATXN Live (Watch ATXN Live | AustinTexas.gov)
- Emergency Alerts and Information Austintexas.gov/Alerts
- Emergency Alerts and Warnings WarnCentralTexas.org
- NWS Winter Weather https://www.weather.gov/safety/winter
- Ready Central Texas Winter Weather Preparedness https://www.austintexas.gov/winterweather

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Plan Development and Maintenance

Plan Development

The Director of Austin Emergency Management and Travis County Chief Emergency Management Coordinator are responsible for developing and maintaining this annex. This annex shall be approved and promulgated by the Director of Austin Emergency Management and Travis County Chief Emergency Management Coordinator.

Approval and Implementation

The City of Austin and Travis County Hazard Specific Annex – Winter Weather will be approved and promulgated by the Director of Austin Emergency Management and Travis County Chief Emergency Management Coordinator.

Upon adoption, the City of Austin and Travis County Hazard Specific Annex – Winter Weather shall be implemented and serve as the protective action plan for the City of Austin and Travis County.

Distribution of Planning Documents

The Director of Austin Emergency Management and Travis County Chief Emergency Management Coordinator shall determine the distribution of this annex, copies of plans and annexes should be distributed to those individuals, departments, agencies, and organizations tasked in this document. Copies should also be set aside for the EOC and other emergency facilities.

In general, individuals who support the City of Austin and Travis County Hazard Specific Annex – Winter Weather, should also receive a copy of this annex.

Maintenance

Method: Maintenance of the City of Austin and Travis County Hazard Specific Annex – Winter Weather and its annexes include ongoing reviews of content to ensure plans are accurate and following current practices. Maintenance of procedures includes the monitoring of organizational, procedural changes or other incidents that impact processes or procedures. Minor maintenance updates allow for modifications to be made to existing processes or procedures without the need for input from a larger stakeholder group or an extended review process.

Schedule: City of Austin and Travis County Hazard Specific Annex – Winter Weather shall be reviewed annually. AEM and TCOEM will establish a schedule for annual review of planning documents by those tasked in them.

Update and Revision

Method: The City of Austin and Travis County Hazard Specific Annex – Winter Weather will be updated based upon deficiencies identified during actual emergency situations and exercises and when changes in threat hazards, resources and capabilities, or government structure occur. Responsibility for revising or updating the annexes to this hazard specific annex is outlined in Assignment of Responsibilities and references this section for instruction.

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Schedule: City of Austin and Travis County Hazard Specific Annex – Winter Weather must be revised or updated by a formal change at least every three years. Responsibility for revising or updating is assigned to AEM and TCOEM. Requires participation by all stakeholders. Revised or updated planning documents will be provided to all departments, agencies, and individuals tasked in those documents.

All departments will provide most current version of SOPs demonstrating alignment with the annex to AEM and TCOEM for review.

Evaluation

Method: Evaluation of the City of Austin and Travis County Hazard Specific Annex – Winter Weather involve exercising and/or testing them through exercises and real-world incidents. AEM and TCOEM are responsible for organizing and conducting a critique following the conclusion of a significant emergency event/incident or exercise. The After-Action Report (AAR) will entail both written and verbal input from all appropriate participants. An Improvement Plan will be developed based on the deficiencies identified, and an individual, department, or agency will be assigned responsibility for correcting the deficiency and a due date shall be established for that action to sustain continuous improvement.

Schedule: Evaluation of the City of Austin and Travis County Hazard Specific Annex – Winter Weather is ongoing but occurs at least annually.

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Appendix 1: Operational Response by Phases- Best Practices

STEADY STATE / MONITORING

STATUS	ESF	ACTIONS
Normal Operations	5	Monitor National Weather Service (NWS Austin/San Antonio) winter weather products; maintain situational awareness of forecasts and decision support briefings.
	5	Maintain coordination with city/county departments and partner agencies.
	5/15	Review pre-scripted winter weather messaging and notification flowcharts (IPAWS/ReadyCentralTexas).
	1/3	Confirm availability of roadway treatment assets (treatment solution trucks, snowplow attachments).
	5/6/8	Review shelter readiness posture between Austin Emergency Management Mass Care Unit, Homeless Strategies Office (HSO) and Austin Public Health (APH).

PHASE 1 – WINTER WEATHER WATCH / FORECASTED IMPACT (24–72 HOURS OUT)

STAGE	ESF	ACTIONS
Phase 1	15	Messaging – Encourage residents to register for ReadyCentralTexas; prepare homes for freezing temperatures; check on vulnerable neighbors.
	5	Conduct coordination call with city/county departments and partner agencies.
	7	Departments identify anticipated resource needs and submit requests for winter weather equipment, supplies, and specialized resources (e.g., tire chains, traction devices, generators, fuel, deicing materials, cold-weather PPE, and vehicle support equipment) to ensure procurement and staging prior to impacts.
	1/3	Pre-treat city/county roads, and critical corridors as necessary.
	5/6	Prepare warming center posturing; coordinate with Parks & Recreation, and HSO if needed.
	3/12	Inspect critical water/wastewater infrastructure for freeze mitigation readiness.
	15	Messaging – Safe space heater use, pipe insulation, and generator safety.
	ALL	Review staffing plans; prepare for potential EOC activation.

WINTER WEATHER

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PHASE 2 – WINTER WEATHER WARNING / IMPACT IMMINENT OR OCCURRING

STAGE	ESF	ACTIONS
Phase 2	5	Consider partial or full EOC activation (physical or virtual).
	5	Schedule operational briefings; establish cost-tracking guidance and WebEOC reporting expectations.
	15	Schedule press briefings (include ASL interpreter and multilingual messaging).
	15	Issue geo-targeted ReadyCentralTexas messaging (travel advisories, warming center locations, transit impacts).
	1/13	Implement roadway closures as needed; coordinate with APD for barricades and traffic control.
	3/12/15	Monitor and respond to water main breaks; coordinate boil water notices if necessary.
	5/12	Coordinate with Austin Energy (AE) on outage response and restoration priorities (hospitals, critical facilities).
	5/6	Activate warming centers / cold weather shelters if threshold criteria are met.
	8/19	GIS to identify critical infrastructure and vulnerable populations in anticipated impact zones.
	4/21	Austin Fire Department (AFD) and Austin-Travis County EMS conduct emergency response operations.
	13	Austin Police Department (APD) secure hazardous areas and assist with welfare checks.
	ALL	Conduct initial damage and impact assessments of city/county facilities and infrastructure.

PHASE 3 – SUSTAINED IMPACT / EXTENDED OUTAGES

STAGE	ESF	ACTIONS
Phase 3	7	Identify resource staging areas if prolonged response required.
	5/6	Expand warming center capacity if outages exceed 24–48 hours.
	5	Coordinate with Travis County and Texas Division of Emergency Management (TDEM).
	8/19	Provide GIS outage overlays and vulnerable population mapping to EOC.
	15	Messaging – Avoid travel; generator safety; carbon monoxide risks; shelter availability.
	5/6/14	Coordinate with American Red Cross and VOAD partners for shelter support and commodities.



STAGE	ESF	ACTIONS
	7	Consider Points of Distribution (POD) for water or commodities if infrastructure disruption is prolonged.
	15	Schedule press briefings (include ASL interpreter and multilingual messaging).
	13	Secure closed roadways and critical infrastructure areas.

TRANSITION TO RECOVERY

PHASE	ESF	ACTIONS
Short-Term Recovery	5/16	Initiate coordination with TDEM and FEMA if threshold indicators met.
	3/5/16	Continue infrastructure damage assessments.
	12	Prioritize power restoration to critical facilities.
	15	Messaging – post-freeze pipe repair guidance; insurance information; contractor fraud prevention.
	5/6	Maintain standby shelter posture if secondary freeze or additional impacts forecast.

PHASE	ESF	ACTIONS
Intermediate Recovery	3/16	Debris removal operations
Up to	5	Public assistance coordination
6 months	ALL	Infrastructure repair tracking
	ALL	Cost documentation for potential state/federal reimbursement

PHASE	ESF	ACTIONS
Long-Term Recovery	ALL	Infrastructure hardening improvements
Longer than	ALL	After-Action Review and Improvement Plan
6 months	ALL	Mitigation project development
	ALL	Policy or ordinance review if operational gaps identified

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Appendix 2: Winter Weather EOC Agencies

Below is a list of agencies and entities that may be called into the Austin-Travis County EOC for winter weather emergencies. This list is solely meant as a guideline and not a definitive list of EOC responders.

City of Austin
• Austin Emergency Management (AEM)
• Austin Transportation and Public Works (ATPW)
○ Street and Bridge Operations (SBO)
○ Arterial Management (Signals)
• Austin Police Department (APD)
• Austin Fire Department (AFD)
• Austin-Travis County Emergency Medical Services (A-TCEMS)
• Communications and Engagement (ACE)
• Austin Energy (AE)
• Austin Resource Recovery (ARR)
• Austin Water Utility (AWU)
• Technology Services (ATS)
• Parks and Recreation (PARD)
• Fleet Mobility Services Department (FMSD)
• 3-1-1
• Austin Public Health (APH)
• Equity Office
• Watershed Protection Department (WPD)
• Development Services Department, Austin Code
• Office of Real Estate Services (ORES)
• Office of Sustainability
• Office of Resiliency
Travis County
• Office of Emergency Management (TCOEM)
• Transportation and Natural Resources (TNR)**
• Sheriff's Office (TCSO)**
• Capital Area Fire Chiefs Association (CAFCA)**
• Other Municipalities**
• Pedernales Electric
• Travis County Health & Human Services (HHS)
State and Other

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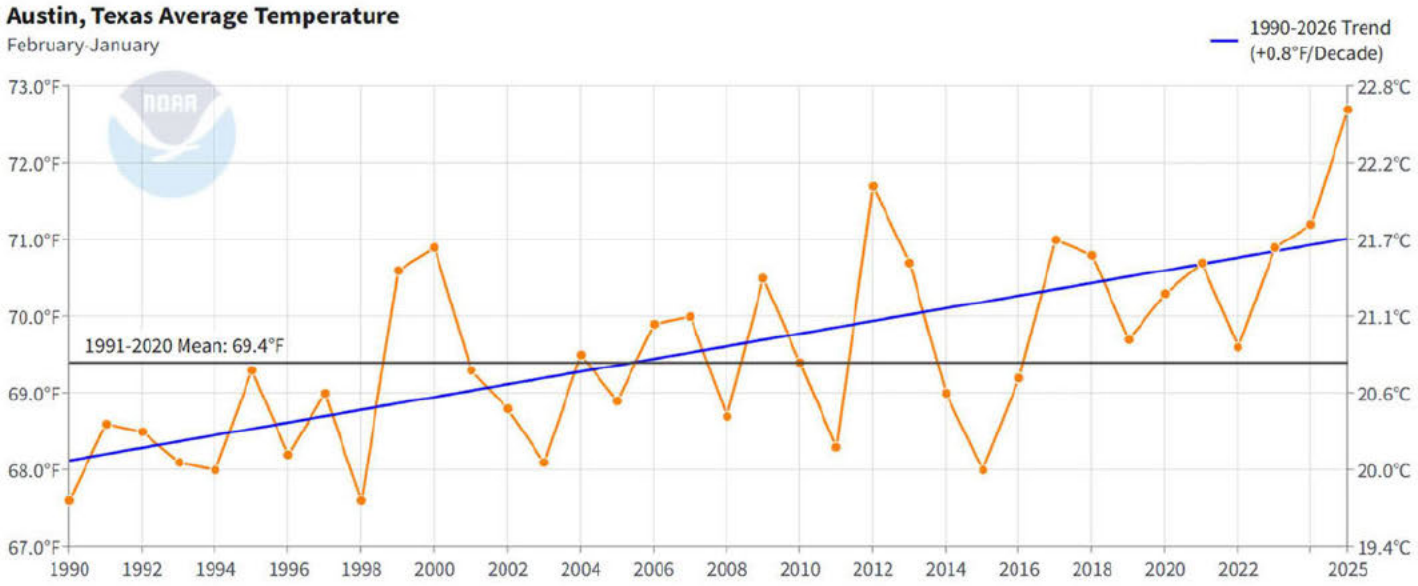
• Texas Department of Transportation (TXDOT)
• Capital Metro
• Austin Community College (ACC)
• Austin Independent School District (AISD)
• American Red Cross*
• University of Texas Police Department (UTPD)
• School Safety Consortium*
• Amateur Radio Emergency Services (ARES)*
• Department of Public Safety (DPS)
• Capital Area of Texas Regional Advisory Council (CATRAC)*
• Area Hospitals*
• Lower Colorado River Authority (LCRA)*
• Williamson County*
• City of Round Rock*
• Hays County*

*Notification will be made, but initial response to the EOC may not be required. **Indicates that primary notification will be made by TCOEM.
Typical Notification will be made by pager via Groups 1 and 2.



Appendix 3: Austin Central Texas Climate Information

The climate data below lists the average temperature and rainfall for the Austin area from 1990-2025. The highest and lowest temperatures are the all-time highs and lows for the period of record. For more complete climate information, you can obtain an official record from the National Centers for Environmental Information, in Asheville, North Carolina. Telephone number 1-828-271-4800. Internet: https://www.ncei.noaa.gov/



NOAA National Centers for Environmental information, Climate at a Glance: City Time Series, published February 2026, retrieved on February 17, 2026, from https://www.ncei.noaa.gov/access/monitoring/climate-at-a-glance/city/time-series

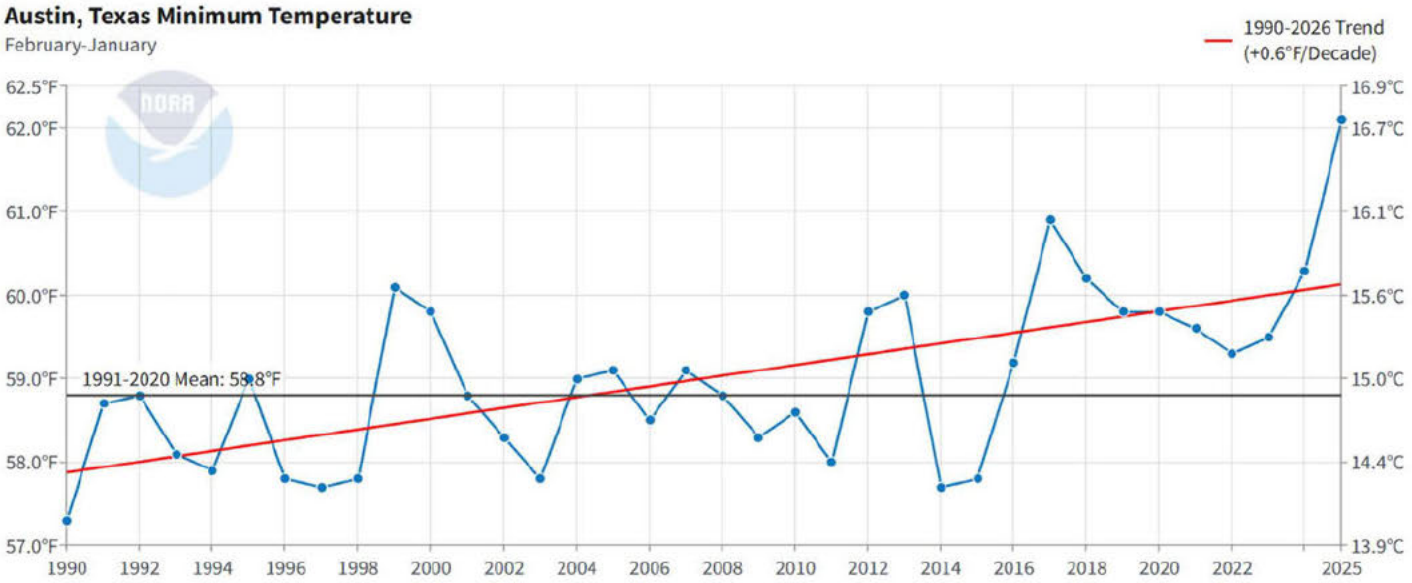
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Austin, Texas Average Temperature (Feb. 1989-Jan. 2026)

Period	Average Temperature (°F)	Rank (out of 87)
February 2025-January 2026	72.4°F	86
February 2024-January 2025	72.7°F	87
February 2023-January 2024	71.2°F	84
February 2022-January 2023	70.9°F	82*
February 2021-January 2022	69.6°F	69
February 2020-January 2021	70.7°F	79*
February 2019-January 2020	70.3°F	75
February 2018-January 2019	69.7°F	71*
February 2017-January 2018	70.8°F	80
February 2016-January 2017	71.0°F	83
February 2015-January 2016	69.2°F	63*
February 2014-January 2015	68.0°F	34*
February 2013-January 2014	69.0°F	61*
February 2012-January 2013	70.7°F	79*
February 2011-January 2012	71.7°F	85
February 2010-January 2011	68.3°F	44*
February 2009-January 2010	69.4°F	67*
February 2008-January 2009	70.5°F	76
February 2007-January 2008	68.7°F	55
February 2006-January 2007	70.0°F	74
February 2005-January 2006	69.9°F	73*
February 2004-January 2005	68.9°F	59*
February 2003-January 2004	69.5°F	68
February 2002-January 2003	68.1°F	38*
February 2001-January 2002	68.8°F	56
February 2000-January 2001	69.3°F	65*
February 1999-January 2000	70.9°F	82*
February 1998-January 1999	70.6°F	77
February 1997-January 1998	67.6°F	25*
February 1996-January 1997	69.0°F	61*
February 1995-January 1996	68.2°F	42*
February 1994-January 1995	69.3°F	65*
February 1993-January 1994	68.0°F	34*
February 1992-January 1993	68.1°F	38*
February 1991-January 1992	68.5°F	52*
February 1990-January 1991	68.6°F	54*
February 1989-January 1990	67.6°F	25*





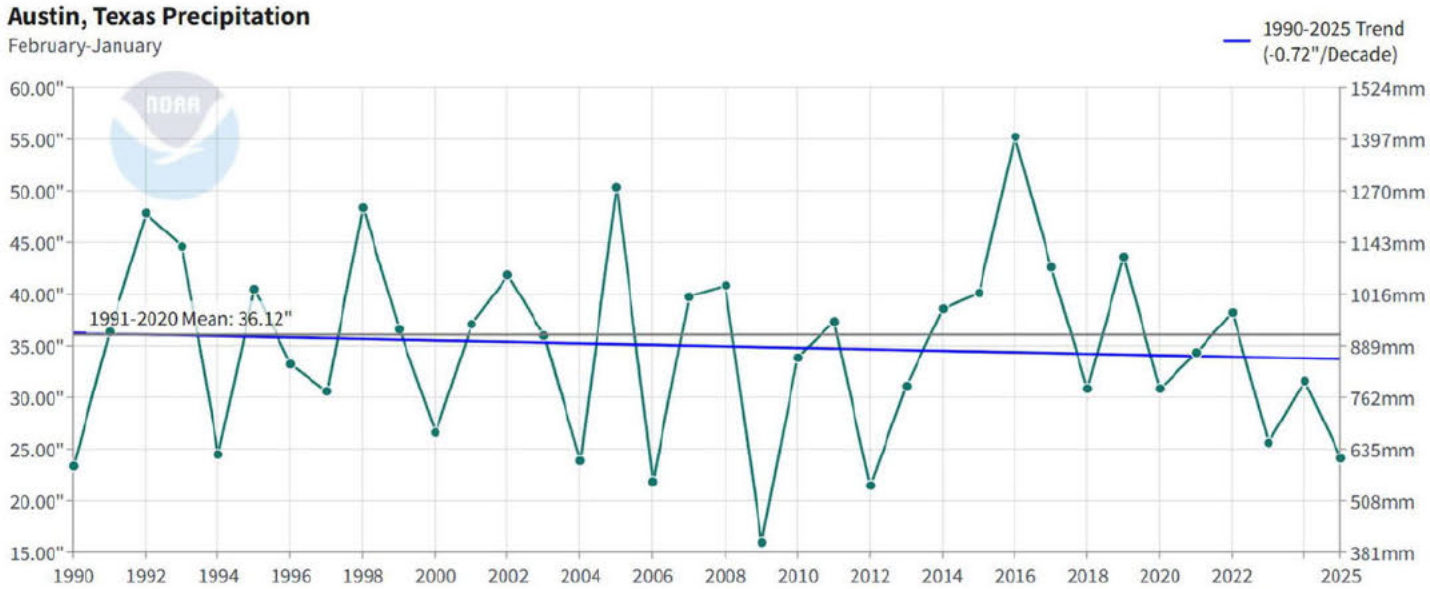
NOAA National Centers for Environmental information, Climate at a Glance: City Time Series, published February 2026, retrieved on February 17, 2026, from https://www.ncei.noaa.gov/access/monitoring/climate-at-a-glance/city/time-series

Austin, Texas Minimum Temperature (Feb. 1989-Jan. 2026)

Period	Minimum Temperature (°F)	Rank (out of 87)
February 2025-January 2026	61.1°F	86
February 2024-January 2025	62.1°F	87
February 2023-January 2024	60.3°F	84
February 2022-January 2023	59.5°F	75
February 2021-January 2022	59.3°F	74
February 2020-January 2021	59.6°F	76
February 2019-January 2020	59.8°F	80*
February 2018-January 2019	59.8°F	80*
February 2017-January 2018	60.2°F	83
February 2016-January 2017	60.9°F	85
February 2015-January 2016	59.2°F	73
February 2014-January 2015	57.8°F	36*
February 2013-January 2014	57.7°F	32*
February 2012-January 2013	60.0°F	81
February 2011-January 2012	59.8°F	80*
February 2010-January 2011	58.0°F	44*
February 2009-January 2010	58.6°F	59
February 2008-January 2009	58.3°F	53*
February 2007-January 2008	58.8°F	67*



February 2006-January 2007	59.1°F	72*
February 2005-January 2006	58.5°F	58*
February 2004-January 2005	59.1°F	72*
February 2003-January 2004	59.0°F	70*
February 2002-January 2003	57.8°F	36*
February 2001-January 2002	58.3°F	53*
February 2000-January 2001	58.8°F	67*
February 1999-January 2000	59.8°F	80*
February 1998-January 1999	60.1°F	82
February 1997-January 1998	57.8°F	36*
February 1996-January 1997	57.7°F	32*
February 1995-January 1996	57.8°F	36*
February 1994-January 1995	59.0°F	70*
February 1993-January 1994	57.9°F	41*
February 1992-January 1993	58.1°F	48*
February 1991-January 1992	58.8°F	67*
February 1990-January 1991	58.7°F	62*
February 1989-January 1990	57.3°F	21*



NOAA National Centers for Environmental information, Climate at a Glance: City Time Series, published February 2026, retrieved on February 17, 2026, from https://www.ncei.noaa.gov/access/monitoring/climate-at-a-glance/city/time-series

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Austin, Texas Precipitation (Feb. 1989-Jan. 2026)

Period	Precipitation (in)	Rank (out of 86)
February 2024-January 2025	24.20"	16
February 2023-January 2024	31.65"	37
February 2022-January 2023	25.67"	19
February 2021-January 2022	38.32"	62
February 2020-January 2021	34.35"	45
February 2019-January 2020	30.87"	32
February 2018-January 2019	43.66"	77
February 2017-January 2018	30.88"	33
February 2016-January 2017	42.67"	76
February 2015-January 2016	55.30"	86
February 2014-January 2015	40.13"	68
February 2013-January 2014	38.62"	64
February 2012-January 2013	31.20"	34
February 2011-January 2012	21.47"	7
February 2010-January 2011	37.38"	60
February 2009-January 2010	33.94"	44
February 2008-January 2009	16.01"	3
February 2007-January 2008	40.85"	71
February 2006-January 2007	39.83"	67
February 2005-January 2006	21.92"	9



February 2004-January 2005	50.37"	84
February 2003-January 2004	23.87"	13
February 2002-January 2003	36.04"	53*
February 2001-January 2002	41.86"	74
February 2000-January 2001	37.17"	59
February 1999-January 2000	26.62"	22
February 1998-January 1999	36.66"	57
February 1997-January 1998	48.42"	83
February 1996-January 1997	30.60"	31
February 1995-January 1996	33.25"	41
February 1994-January 1995	40.56"	70
February 1993-January 1994	24.57"	17
February 1992-January 1993	44.66"	79
February 1991-January 1992	47.85"	82
February 1990-January 1991	36.40"	56
February 1989-January 1990	23.40"	12

NOTE: FOR ALL TIME HIGH AND LOW TEMPERATURES
Austin/Mabry and from previous climate sites 1897 to Present
Austin/Bergstrom Jan. to Sep. 1943 to Present and Oct. to Dec. 1942 to Present
Freeze Data - From the Previous Austin Mueller Airport Location to Present, 1926 to 2015

- Earliest Freeze Record - October 26, 1924
- Latest Freeze Record - April 3, 1987

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Appendix 6: Definitions

Freezing Rain: Rain that falls in liquid form but freezes upon impact with the ground to form a coating or glaze of ice on the ground and exposed objects.
Freezing Drizzle: Drizzle that falls in liquid form but freezes upon impact to form a coating or glaze of ice on the ground.
Sleet / Ice Pellets: Precipitation consisting of transparent or translucent pellets of ice, 0.2 inches or less in diameter. Rain that turns to ice pellets before reaching the ground.
Watch: These are issued when the risk of a hazardous weather event has increased significantly, but its occurrence, locations, and/or timing is still uncertain. It is intended to provide enough lead time so those who need to set their plans in motion can do so.
Warning/Advisory: These are issued when a hazardous weather event is occurring, is imminent, or has a high probability of occurrence. A winter storm warning/heavy snow warning /ice storm warning is used for conditions posing a threat to life or property.
Advisories (for example, winter weather advisory, freezing rain advisory, etc.) may be issued indicating less serious conditions that cause significant inconvenience and, if caution is not exercised, could lead to situations that may threaten life and/or property.
National Weather Service (NWS) Winter Weather Related Products Watches and Warnings
Watch vs. Warning
Winter Storm Watch: Dangerous winter weather is possible within 48 hours. Considerable travel problems are possible. Confidence is Medium. You should prepare.
Winter Storm Warning: Dangerous winter weather is expected within the next 12-36 hours or is occurring. Considerable travel programs are expected. You should take action.
Winter Storm Advisory: Potentially dangerous winter weather is expected within the next 12 to 36 hours or is occurring. Travel difficulties are expected. You should be aware.

The National Weather Service (NWS) has updated the 2026 Winter product criteria. Criteria is mainly coordination before the event.

Winter Weather Advisory: Travel impacts are minimal. Overpasses are likely affected or there could be slick spots. Ice accumulation of glaze or equal to 1/8 inch. Snow is trace amount to 2 inches. Sleet is a trace amount to 1/2 inch.
Winter Storm Warning: Travel impacts are significant, major roads affected. Snow, freezing rain, or sleet occur. Some power outages. Ice accumulation greater than 1/8 inch. Snow is equal or greater than 2 inches. Sleet is equal or greater to 1/2 inch.
Ice Storm Warning: Significant Ice (freezing rain) accumulation). Widespread power outages are likely. Greater than or equal to 1/4 inch.

Note: Forecast impacts, or known impacts to travel can be reason to issue, upgrade, or downgrade winter products.

There has been a change in the extreme cold and wind chill consolidation with renaming for the 2025/2026 season. This provides the opportunity to establish improved threshold for communicating dangerous cold with or without wind. See diagram below.

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WINTER WEATHER

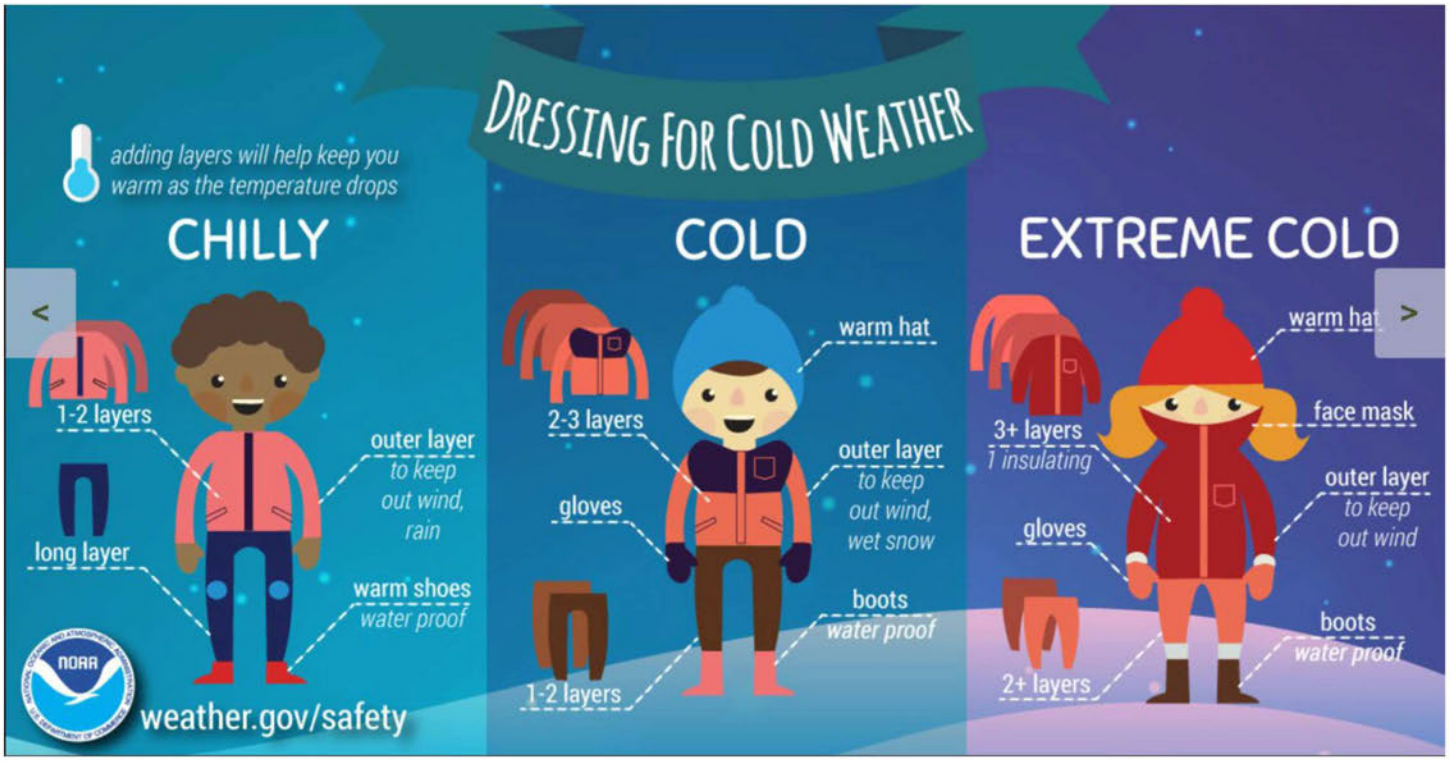
Hazard-Specific Annex



Extreme Cold Consolidation and Renaming

Last Winter		2024/2025 Winter
Extreme Cold Watch Wind Chill Watch	Consolidated to →	Extreme Cold Watch
Extreme Cold Warning Wind Chill Warning	Consolidated to →	Extreme Cold Warning
Wind Chill Advisory	Replaced with →	Cold Weather Advisory

Freeze Warnings – The freeze program is designed around Agriculture users/partners. "Freeze" and "Hard Freeze" warnings will be combined. The definition for "hard freeze is temperature at or below 28 degrees. Frozen pipes and plant/tree damage are the most common "hard freeze" impacts.



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Appendix 7: Acronyms

ACC	Austin Community College
ACE	Austin Communications and Engagement
AE	Austin Energy
AEM	Austin Emergency Management
AFD	Austin Fire Department
AISD	Austin Independent School District
APD	Austin Police Department
ARES	Amateur Radio Emergency Services
ART	After Hour Response Team (Travis County)
A-TCEMS	Austin-Travis County Emergency Medical Services
ATS	Austin Technology Services
AWACS	Austin Warning and Communications System
AW	Austin Water
CAFCA	Capital Area Fire Chiefs Association
CATRAC	Capital Area of Texas Regional Advisory Council
CTECC	Combined Transportation, Emergency and Communications Center
CWS	Cold Weather Shelter
DPS	Department of Public Safety
EOC	Emergency Operations Center
FSMD	Fleet Mobility Services
LCRA	Lower Colorado River Authority
NWS	National Weather Service
PARD	Parks and Recreation Department
SBO	Street and Bridge Operations (Transportation and Public Works)
ROW	Right of Way
SOP	Special Operations Plan
TCOEM	Travis County Office of Emergency Management
TCSO	Travis County Sheriff's Office
TNR	Transportation and Natural Resources
TPW	Transportation and Public Works
TXDOT	Texas Department of Transportation
UT	University of Texas at Austin
UTPD	University of Texas at Austin Police Department